



◀ MFDs:
HP M126NW
Price: ₹12,075

Monochrome MFDs

Let's be frank, this is the most boring category in this test but it's also an understandably neglected one. When it comes to monochrome MFDs, especially laser ones, there's really no difference in quality that'll matter to the average person. What matters more is reliability and consistency and of course, the cost of printing. Since we're only interested in performance here, we'll strictly focus on reliability and consistency and thus we measure the ability of the printer to reliably print a few 100 pages of mixed content, the speed at which it does this and the consistency of the output. We also test for alignment and other miscellaneous aspects.

Zero1 Winner

HP M126NW

The M126NW stood out with its text quality, and even more surprisingly, image quality. If that wasn't enough, the print speed was also impressive. Do bear in mind that we're only comparing this to other laser printers. Expecting stellar black and white photo prints from a laser printer is simply asking for too much. It's a well-built printer and proved to be quite reliable in testing. Other than at the highest print quality settings, it never really struggled.

Worthy Mentions

Brother DCP L2541DW

Brother has always been a brand that's given us consistently good performance in even the worst of situations the DCP L2541DW doesn't disappoint. We're happy to report that this is a sturdy, feature-packed printer that performs quite well and handles large print loads with ease. The only reason it's not winning Zero1 is because the HP has better print quality. But honestly, only the most discerning of buyers will really care that much about print quality.



Brother DCP L2541DW
Price: ₹16,350



Netgear Nighthawk R7000
Price: ₹20,699

Routers

There has been a bump in overall throughput which was unexpected since we hadn't seen any implementation of the new chips from Broadcom, and Broadcom was powering every flagship router last year. Turns out the show stopper turned out to be a competitor this time – Quantenna. Their QSR1000 is the reason behind the winner this year with a 4x4 configuration ensuring more spatial streams to work with. However, in August Netgear announced the R8000 Nighthawk which is a successor to the R7000 released last year with the new Broadcom chips. However, the new Broadcom chips were still 3x3 so to get more throughput Netgear introduced another band. We've even seen economy routers under ₹3,000 with support for 802.11ac.

Zero1 Winner

ASUS RT-AC87U

The RT-AC87U happens to be the first Wave 2 router to hit the market with the major improvement being MU MIMO and 4 spatial streams. However, the final implementation of Wave 2 routers will see a much larger jump in throughput which we are eagerly waiting to see. The RT-AC87U at the end of the day provides greater throughput on a per-client basis compared to the competition.

Worthy Mentions

Netgear Nighthawk R7000

It was unfortunate that we couldn't get the R8000 in time for the test. However, the R7000 is not a bad router at all. Price drops over the last year have made it a lot more budget friendly. The throughput increment of the R8000 over the R7000 is massive so unless you're in need of the extra bandwidth you can make do with the R7000.



▲ ROUTERS: **ASUS RT-AC87U**
Price: ₹24,500